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Placement Contacts

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References

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Research Interests

My research is in applied microeconomics, with a specialization in labor economics and the economics of education. I use causal inference methods with large-scale administrative and survey data. My current work examines how family and educational environments shape human capital accumulation, child well-being, and gender disparities.

Education

• **University of California, Riverside** — Riverside, CA, USA
Ph.D. in Economics — *Sep. 2021 – Jun. 2027 (expected)*
• **Jinan University** — Guangzhou, China
M.S. in Economics, with Honors — *Sep. 2019 – Jun. 2021*
• **Zhongnan University of Economics and Law** — Wuhan, China
B.S. in Economics, with Honors — *Sep. 2014 – Jun. 2019*

Job Market Paper

• **Gender Peer Effects and Women's Academic Performance in Mathematics: Evidence from a U.S. University Qiu, Z.** *Job market paper.* [Link]

Abstract: Understanding women's progress in mathematics can help explain their continued underrepresentation in mathematics-intensive fields. Using administrative records from a U.S. university, I exploit variation in female peer share across introductory mathematics classes taught by a given instructor within an academic term. A 10-percentage-point increase raises women's completion probability by 3.1 percentage points, corresponding to approximately 10 more female classmates and 1.4 additional completions among women already enrolled in an average-sized class. Benefits are concentrated among women entering with a STEM major, with broader first-term gains for both genders. Longer-term estimates provide suggestive evidence of increased STEM degree attainment among women entering with a STEM major.

Publication

[1] **Punching Out, Not Down: The Impact of Paid Sick Leave on Child Maltreatment**. **Qiu, Z.** *Labour Economics*, 2026, Article 102958. [Link]

Selected Work in Progress

• **Effects of Faculty Gender Attitudes on College Students' Short- and Long-Term Outcomes.** With Radhika Bansal (University of California, Riverside), Ozkan Eren (University of California, Riverside), Krzysztof Karbownik (Emory University), and Ruinan Zhao (State of California Department of Industrial Relations).

- Link university records (2013–2024) with faculty Gender-Science Implicit Association Test responses to study student achievement, major choice, graduation, and earnings.
- Preliminary findings associate stronger instructor gender bias with female students leaving their declared majors and a lower likelihood of on-time graduation.

• **The Impact of Marriage Tax Bonus and Penalty on Marital Decisions in the U.S.** With Zhe Yang (Liaoning University).

- Use SIPP data and an instrumental-variable strategy based on state and demographic variation to estimate how marriage tax incentives affect marriage formation and dissolution.
- A 1% increase in the marriage-bonus-to-income ratio increases cohabiting couples' likelihood of marriage by 0.12%.

Technical and Policy Reports

[1] **The State of Work in the Inland Empire Part II: Pandemic, Polarization, Inflation, and Investment**. Bates, M., Bruene, S., Calderon, E. E., De La Torre, E., Freire, P., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Jackson, K., Kapoor, M., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Reese, E., Rettberg, G., and Tamayose, B. C. *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside*, 2023. [Link]

[2] **The State of Work: Transportation, Distribution, and Logistics in the Inland Empire**. Bainiwal, T. S., Bates, M., Brookes, M., Bruene, S., Calderon, E., Carranza, N., De La Torre, E., Freire, P., Gudis, C., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Jackson, K., Kapoor, M., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Reese, E., Rettberg, G., Tamayose, B., and Tan, A. *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside*, 2024. [Link]

[3] **Thrive Inland SoCal: Labor Market Analysis**. Bates, M., Brookes, M., Bruene, S., Burnett, J., Calderon, E., Carbajal, A., De La Torre, E., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Kapoor, M., Mukenge, K., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Rana, S., Reese, E., Rettberg, G., Salam, I., and Tamayose, B. *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside*, 2024. [Link]

Teaching Experience

• **University of California, Riverside** — Riverside, CA, USA

*Instructor of Record (avg. evaluation: **4.78/5**)* — *Aug. 2025*

- Urban Economics *(Sum. 2025)*

*Teaching Assistant (avg.: **6.56/7** for sections w/ enroll. $>$ 10 & resp. rate $>$ campus avg.)* — *Oct. 2022 – Present*

- Introductory Econometrics *(F. 2022; W. 2023; W. & F. 2024; W., Spr., & F. 2025; W. 2026)*
- Statistics for Economics *(F. 2023)*
- Intermediate Microeconomic Theory *(Spr. 2024; Spr. 2026)*

Software Instructor — *Jul. – Aug. 2023*

- Stata Boot Camp, Master of Public Policy Program

Pedagogical Training — *Jul. 2026*

- Summer Curriculum Design Institute

Research Experience

• **Department of Economics, University of California, Riverside**
for Prof. Veronica Sovero, Graduate Student Researcher — *Jul. – Sep. 2026*

• **Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside**
Graduate Student Researcher — *Apr. – Jun. 2023*

• **Peking University HSBC Business School**
for Prof. Yizhen Gu, Research Assistant — *Dec. 2020 – Jun. 2021*

• **Guangzhou Academy of Social Sciences**
Research Assistant — *Aug. – Dec. 2020*

Presentations and Talks

- Economic Seminar Series, California State University Long Beach *(scheduled)* *2026*
- Southern Economic Association (SEA) 96th Annual Meeting *(department nominated, scheduled)* *2026*
- International Symposium on Contemporary Labor Economics, Xiamen University *2025*
- Southern Economic Association (SEA) 95th Annual Meeting *2025*
- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Annual Fall Conference *2025*
- 18th All-California Labor Economics Conference–Poster Session, Stanford University *2025*
- China Economics Society (CES) China Annual Conference, Sun Yat-sen University *2025*
- SEMi-Talk Academic Workshop, Tsinghua University *2024*
- 15th All-California Labor Economics Conference–Poster Session, University of California, Riverside *2022*

Referee Service

- Journal of Labor Research

Honors and Awards

- Dean's Distinguished Fellowship, University of California, Riverside *2021 – Present*
- Outstanding Graduate Award, Jinan University *2019 – 2021*

Skills

Software: Stata, Python, MATLAB, R, SQL, LaTeX, Qualtrics
Additional Skills: Policy report writing, survey design, data visualization
Language: English (Proficient); Mandarin (Native); Cantonese; Hakka